

What Changed Under the Exam

Correct answers describing services you can no longer buy.

SCOPE All domains TYPE Availability warnings MODULE 22 of 26

Answer from the **documented exam catalogue**. Know the reality so the contradiction does not shake you.

Why this gap exists

- ◆ CLF-C02 launched in September 2023. Its question pool was written before most of these changes.
- ◆ AWS ran two large portfolio culls, in July 2024 and again in late 2025.
- ◆ **The exam guide's in-scope service list is updated more often than the question pool is rewritten.**
- ◆ That means some questions in circulation test services the current guide no longer lists at all.
- ◆ Where the guide and an old question bank disagree, trust the guide.

ON THE EXAM

The in-scope list in the official exam guide is the most current thing AWS publishes about this exam. Read it yourself.

The AWS Snow Family is **gone**. Snowball support ends on the thirty first of December, twenty twenty six.

The Snow Family timeline

DEVICE	WHAT HAPPENED
AWS Snowmobile	Retired March 2024. The shipping container never returns.
AWS Snowcone	Discontinued 12 Nov 2024. Existing support ended 12 Nov 2025.
Older Snowball models	Discontinued 12 Nov 2024, support ended 12 Nov 2025.
AWS Snowball Edge	Closed to new customers 7 Nov 2025. Existing customers only.
All Snowball devices	Support ends in commercial Regions on 31 Dec 2026.

THE GAP

The Snow Family no longer appears on the CLF-C02 in-scope service list at all. Older banks still test it heavily.

What replaced offline transfer

THE OLD ANSWER

Ship a physical device

- Petabytes over a slow or absent link
- Weeks of shipping and handling
- Snowball, Snowcone, Snowmobile
- Now unavailable to new customers

THE CURRENT ANSWER

Transfer online, or use a terminal

- AWS DataSync for managed online transfer
- AWS Data Transfer Terminal for physical drop-off
- AWS Direct Connect for a dedicated private link
- AWS Outposts where the need is edge compute

EXAM VERSUS REALITY

If an old-style question describes shipping petabytes, the expected answer is still a Snow device. In practice the answer is DataSync.

Developer, Business and Enterprise On-Ramp Support **all retire on the first of January, twenty twenty seven.**

Support plans, old and new

EXAMINABLE TODAY	WHAT IS REPLACING IT
Basic Support, free	Basic Support, unchanged and still free
Developer Support	Business Support+, from \$29/month. Retires 1 Jan 2027.
Business Support	Business Support+, 30-minute critical response. Retires 1 Jan 2027.
Enterprise On-Ramp	Auto-upgraded to Enterprise through 2026. Retires 1 Jan 2027.
Enterprise Support	Enterprise Support, minimum cut from \$15,000 to \$5,000/month
(did not exist)	Unified Operations, from \$50,000/month

THE GAP

The exam still names Developer, Business, Enterprise On-Ramp and Enterprise. Answer with those four.

What still holds about support plans

- ◆ **Basic is free** and gives documentation, whitepapers, re:Post, the Health Dashboard and core Trusted Advisor checks.
- ◆ **A Technical Account Manager first appears at Enterprise.** That has always been the giveaway.
- ◆ **Business is the first tier with 24/7 phone and chat** and the full set of Trusted Advisor checks.
- ◆ **Enterprise gives 15-minute response** for business-critical systems down. Enterprise On-Ramp gives 30 minutes.
- ◆ Do not answer with Business Support+ or Unified Operations. Those names are not in the exam pool.

ON THE EXAM

Business-critical or mission-critical plus a named TAM means Enterprise Support. That mapping is unchanged.

Renamed, closed, or off the list

SERVICE	STATUS
Amazon QuickSight	Renamed Amazon Quick Suite Oct 2025, then Amazon Quick. Guide says Amazon Quick Sight.
Amazon SageMaker	Now Amazon SageMaker AI in the exam guide.
AWS Security Hub	Renamed Security Hub CSPM Jun 2025. A new, different service took the name.
Amazon Q Business	Closed to new customers 31 Jul 2026, folding into Amazon Quick.
Amazon CodeCatalyst	Closed to new customers 7 Nov 2025. Not on the in-scope list.
AWS CodeCommit	Closed to new customers 25 Jul 2024. Not on the in-scope list.
AWS Cloud9	Closed to new customers 25 Jul 2024. Use IDE toolkits or CloudShell.
Amazon Forecast	Closed to new customers 25 Jul 2024. Use SageMaker Canvas.
S3 Select, CloudSearch, SimpleDB, Data Pipeline	All closed to new customers 25 Jul 2024.

THE GAP

Older banks use several of these as correct answers. CodeCatalyst as the CI/CD answer is the most common.

Services older banks test that are now out of scope

- ◆ **AWS CloudShell** appears as a correct answer in older banks. It is on the out-of-scope list.
- ◆ **Amazon Personalize, Amazon Fraud Detector, Amazon WorkDocs** are all out of scope now.
- ◆ **AWS Billing Conductor, AWS Data Exchange, Amazon Keyspaces, Amazon MemoryDB** are out of scope.
- ◆ **AWS CodeDeploy and AWS Network Firewall** are out of scope. CodeBuild and CodePipeline are in.
- ◆ Recognising them costs nothing. Studying them costs time you do not have.

ON THE EXAM

The out-of-scope list in the exam guide is as useful as the in-scope one. It tells you what to stop revising.

Reached end of support entirely

SERVICE	WHAT HAPPENED
Amazon QLDB	End of support 31 Jul 2025. Migration path was Aurora PostgreSQL.
Amazon Glacier vaults	The standalone vault service closed to new customers 15 Dec 2025.
AWS WAF Classic	Fully retired 30 Sep 2025. The current AWS WAF is unaffected.
DMS Fleet Advisor	End of support 20 May 2026. Not on the in-scope list.

THE GAP

QLDB is the one that bites. If a bank offers it for an immutable ledger, that service no longer exists at all.

Changed, but not removed

THING	WHAT ACTUALLY CHANGED
Root user MFA	Recommended in study material. Enforced on all account types since Jun 2025.
Trusted Advisor	Five check categories became six. Operational excellence added Oct 2023.
AWS Free Tier	Three-part model replaced by a credit model for accounts created after 15 Jul 2025.
AWS Organizations	SCPs joined by resource control policies and declarative policies in late 2024.
Amazon ElastiCache	Valkey added as an engine in Oct 2024, alongside Redis OSS and Memcached.
Classic Load Balancer	Retired in EC2-Classic only. Still supported inside a VPC.

THE GAP

These are the subtle ones. The name is unchanged, so nothing looks wrong until the console disagrees with your notes.

You are sitting the exam. A question describes a company with eighty terabytes of archive data in a facility with a slow, unreliable internet link, needing the data in Amazon S3 within a month.

The options include AWS Snowball Edge, AWS Direct Connect, AWS DataSync, and uploading over the public internet. You know Snowball closed to new customers last November.

What should you select?

- ☐ A AWS Snowball Edge
- ☐ B AWS Direct Connect
- ☐ C AWS DataSync
- ☐ D Upload over the public internet

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should you select?

- A

AWS Snowball Edge
The expected answer. The scoring key was written when Snowball was the offline transfer answer. Select it.
- B

AWS Direct Connect
Takes weeks to provision a circuit and is a permanent link, not a one-off bulk move.
- C

AWS DataSync
The correct real-world answer today, but DataSync is not on the CLF-C02 in-scope list.
- D

Upload over the public internet
The link is described as slow and unreliable. The scenario rules this out explicitly.

THE SIGNAL

Answer the question that was written, not the one current documentation would write. Knowing the difference is the skill.

A question asks which support plan a company should choose. The company runs business-critical production workloads, wants a designated Technical Account Manager, and needs a fifteen-minute response when a production system is down.

The options are AWS Basic Support, AWS Developer Support, AWS Business Support, and AWS Enterprise Support.

Which support plan meets these requirements?

- | | |
|---|---|
| ☐ A AWS Basic Support | ☐ B AWS Developer Support |
| ☐ C AWS Business Support | ☐ D AWS Enterprise Support |

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

Which support plan meets these requirements?

- A

AWS Basic Support
Free tier. No technical support cases at all, let alone a TAM.
- B

AWS Developer Support
Business hours only, and no TAM. Being retired on 1 Jan 2027 in any case.
- C

AWS Business Support
24/7 support and full Trusted Advisor, but no designated TAM. The TAM is the separator.
- D

AWS Enterprise Support
Designated TAM plus 15-minute business-critical response. Both requirements, unchanged in the new lineup.

THE SIGNAL

Two named requirements, TAM and fifteen minutes, both of which only Enterprise has ever met.

You are revising with an older practice bank. One question asks which service a company should use to model, visualise and automate its application release workflow, and gives Amazon CodeCatalyst as the marked answer.

You check the current exam guide and find CodeCatalyst is not listed in scope, but AWS CodePipeline and AWS CodeBuild both are.

What is the right conclusion to draw?

- ☐ A The bank is wrong; learn CodePipeline for this scenario shape
- ☐ B Learn CodeCatalyst thoroughly, since the bank marks it correct
- ☐ C Both services are equally likely to be the answer
- ☐ D CI/CD is no longer tested on this exam

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What is the right conclusion to draw?

- A

 The bank is wrong; learn CodePipeline for this scenario shape
The in-scope list is the more current document. Model, visualise and automate a release workflow is CodePipeline's own description.
- B

 Learn CodeCatalyst thoroughly, since the bank marks it correct
Recognise the name, but a service the guide excludes cannot be a scored answer.
- C

 Both services are equally likely to be the answer
They are not. One is on the in-scope list and one is explicitly absent from it.
- D

 CI/CD is no longer tested on this exam
CodePipeline, CodeBuild and X-Ray are all still in scope under Developer Tools.

THE SIGNAL

When a bank and the in-scope list disagree, the in-scope list wins. It is the more recently updated document.

You created an AWS account last month to practise. At signup you chose a plan, received one hundred dollars in credits, and earned another hundred by completing onboarding tasks. There was no mention of twelve months of anything.

A practice question then asks you to describe the AWS Free Tier, and offers an option naming Always Free, twelve months free, and short-term trials.

What should you select?

- ☐ A The option describing Always Free, twelve months free, and trials
- ☐ B An option describing \$200 of credits over six months
- ☐ C Neither; the question is faulty and should be skipped
- ☐ D Whichever option mentions credits, since that matches your account

◆ PAUSE AND DECIDE

What should you select?

- A

 The option describing Always Free, twelve months free, and trials
The documented model the question pool describes. It is what the scoring key expects.
- B

 An option describing \$200 of credits over six months
Accurate about your own account, and not what the exam is testing. The pool predates the change.
- C

 Neither; the question is faulty and should be skipped
There is no penalty for guessing and no credit for objecting. Never leave a question blank.
- D

 Whichever option mentions credits, since that matches your account
Your personal experience is not evidence about the exam. It is evidence about July 2025 onwards.

THE SIGNAL

This is the whole module in one question. Your own account contradicts the exam, and the exam still wins.

How to use this module

- ◆ **In the exam, answer from the documented catalogue.** The scoring key is not going to argue with you.
- ◆ **Where an in-scope replacement exists, prefer it.** CodePipeline over CodeCatalyst, for example.
- ◆ **Where no in-scope replacement exists, the old answer stands.** Snowball for offline bulk transfer.
- ◆ Read the in-scope and out-of-scope lists in the exam guide yourself. They take ten minutes and they are current.
- ◆ Some changes are removals; others are behaviour moving under an unchanged name. Watch for both.

ON THE EXAM

Everything in this module has a date attached. Check it before your exam; AWS keeps changing the catalogue.